

Kamala (detail) · Calcutta Art Studio, 1885–90 · The Met, public domain

श्री महालक्ष्मी पूजन

Lakshmi Puja

The complete guide, step by step

Every step in order, every shloka in Devanagari with its meaning, and the full samagri list.

Sunday 8 November 2026 · in the evening, in pradosh kaal

Following the Gita Press *Nitya Karma Puja Prakash*, Shri Mahalakshmi-pujan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

When, and how to use this guide

When

Lakshmi Puja is done on **Kartik Amavasya, in the evening**. This year that is **Sunday 8 November 2026**. Amavasya runs from 11:27 AM on Sunday to 12:31 PM on Monday (New Delhi). The best time is the **Vrishabha kaal inside pradosh**, the hours just after sunset.

City	Lakshmi Puja muhurat	Pradosh kaal
New Delhi	**5:54 – 7:50 PM**	5:31 – 8:09 PM
Kolkata	**5:20 – 7:18 PM**	4:56 – 7:29 PM
Mumbai	**6:27 – 8:27 PM**	6:02 – 8:34 PM
Chennai	**6:06 – 8:09 PM**	5:40 – 8:09 PM
Bengaluru	**6:17 – 8:20 PM**	5:51 – 8:20 PM

Times from Drik Panchang, Sunday 8 Nov 2026. In London and New York, Lakshmi Puja is also on Sunday 8 Nov, in the evening by local time. For another city, message us on Instagram, @manka.daily.

How this guide is made

The order and the mantras follow the Gita Press *Nitya Karma Puja Prakash* (Shri Mahalakshmi-pujan, pp. 259–276). The full vidhi there is long. It includes prana-pratishtha, the navagraha, the kalash and the puja of the ledgers. This guide keeps the **twelve steps a home can do on its own**. The same book allows worship "*yathalabdhopachara*", with whatever is at hand.

> **If a mantra won't come, say its meaning in your own words.** In every Sanatan practice bhaav comes first. If you can, do the full vidhi with a pandit.
>
> **Every home has its own customs.** Where your family does it differently, keep your family's way.

सामग्री · SAMAGRI

Keep these ready before sunset

Setting up चौकी

- [ ] A chowki or low table
- [ ] Ganeshji's murti or picture
- [ ] A clean plate
- [ ] Chandan with kesar, or kumkum, for the lotus
- [ ] A clean red or yellow cloth
- [ ] Maa Lakshmi's murti or picture
- [ ] Coins or money (द्रव्य-लक्ष्मी)

Asan and purifying आसन · आचमन

- [ ] An asan: wool, kusha or cloth
- [ ] A small spoon (achamani)
- [ ] A lota of clean water
- [ ] Gangajal, if you have it

For the sankalp and for Ganeshji संकल्प · गणेश

- [ ] Akshat (whole rice)
- [ ] Flowers
- [ ] A laddoo or sweet
- [ ] Roli or kumkum for tilak
- [ ] Durva grass

For Maa Lakshmi स्नान · श्रृंगार

- [ ] Panchamrit: milk, curd, ghee, honey, sugar
- [ ] Chandan
- [ ] Akshat coloured with kumkum
- [ ] A flower garland
- [ ] Clean water for her bath
- [ ] Kumkum
- [ ] Red flowers, a lotus if you can

Dhoop, deep and bhog धूप · दीप · नैवेद्य

- [ ] Incense (dhoop or agarbatti)
- [ ] Cotton wicks, matchbox
- [ ] Seasonal fruit
- [ ] A coin for dakshina
- [ ] The main diya, with ghee
- [ ] Mithai
- [ ] Paan leaves, supari, cardamom
- [ ] Kheel and batashe

Diyas and aarti दीपमालिका · आरती

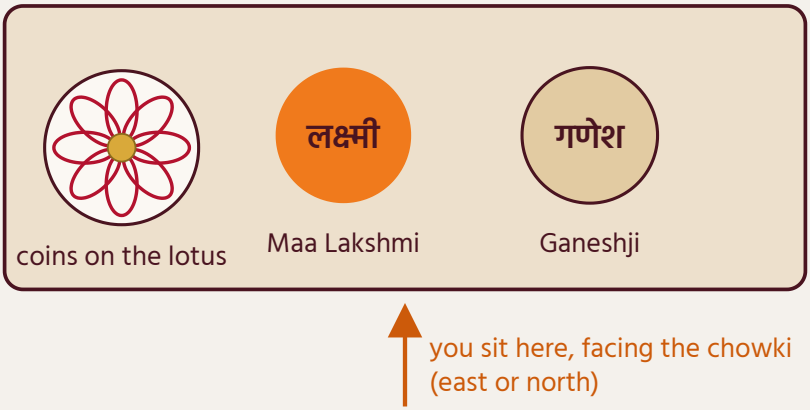
- [ ] 11 or 21 diyas, oil or ghee, wicks
- [ ] A ghee wick for the aarti
- [ ] A bell
- [ ] An aarti thali
- [ ] Camphor
- [ ] Sugarcane, oranges, water chestnuts (by family custom)

Set the place, purify, take the sankalp

1 The chowki
चौकी

Before sunset, clean the house and the puja place, and bathe. Spread a clean cloth on the chowki. Place **Ganeshji, and on his right, Maa Lakshmi**. As you face them, she is on **your left**.

Beside her, on a clean plate, draw an **eight-petal lotus** in saffron chandan (or kumkum) and place your coins on it. The money is worshipped with her.



Gita Press NKPP p. 259: Maa Lakshmi "गणेशजीके दाहिने भागमें", on Ganeshji's right; the lotus "केसरयुक्त चन्दनसे".

2 Asan, achaman, sprinkling
आसन · आचमन · प्रोक्षण

1. Sit on your own asan, facing east or north. Purify the asan:

ॐ पृथ्वि त्वया धृता लोका देवि त्वं विष्णुना धृता ।
त्वं च धारय मां देवि पवित्रं कुरु चासनम् ॥

Om prithvi tvaya dhrita loka devi tvam vishnuna dhrita. Tvam cha dharaya mam devi pavitram kuru chasanam.

Meaning: O Earth, you hold up the worlds, and Vishnu holds you. Hold me too, Devi, and make this seat pure.

2. **Achaman.** Right hand in gokarna mudra (like a cow's ear), with a few drops of water. Sip three times from the base of the thumb, one name each:

ॐ केशवाय नमः । ॐ नारायणाय नमः । ॐ माधवाय नमः ।

Om keshavaya namah. Om narayanaya namah. Om madhavaya namah.

Meaning: Salutations to Keshava, to Narayana, to Madhava.

Wipe the lips and wash the hand: **ॐ हृषीकेशाय नमः । ॐ गोविन्दाय नमः ।** (Some homes say स्वाहा in place of नमः; in the south, अच्युताय · अनन्ताय · गोविन्दाय. Keep your family's way.)

3. **Sprinkle** a little water on yourself and the puja things:

अपवित्रः पवित्रो वा सर्वावस्थां गतोऽपि वा ।
यः स्मरेत्पुण्डरीकाक्षं स बाह्याभ्यन्तरः शुचिः ॥

Apavitrah pavitro va sarvavastham gato'pi va. Yah smaret pundarikaksham sa bahyabhyantarah shuchih.

Meaning: Pure or impure, in whatever state, whoever remembers the lotus-eyed Lord is pure, inside and out.

NKPP (every puja begins this way); the sprinkling verse is from the Garuda Purana. No water at hand? Touching the right ear counts as achaman (Devi Bhagavata 11.3).

3 Sankalp
संकल्प

Take a little water, a few grains of akshat and a flower in your **right hand**. Say your name, your gotra, your city, and that today, on Kartik Amavasya, you do Maa Lakshmi's puja. Then **let it fall near Ganeshji**. Your puja has begun.

The Gita Press sankalp is below. Put your city, gotra and name where it says **अमुक** (amuka). If it is too long, say the same in your own words.

ॐ विष्णवे नमः, ॐ विष्णवे नमः, ॐ विष्णवे नमः। ॐ अद्य ब्रह्मणोऽह्नि द्वितीयपरार्धे श्रीश्वेतवाराहकल्पे वैवस्वतमन्वन्तरेऽष्टाविंशतितमे कलियुगे कलिप्रथमचरणे बौद्धावतारे भूर्लोके जम्बूद्वीपे भरतखण्डे भारतवर्षे अमुकनगरे रौद्रनामसंवत्सरे मासोत्तमे मासे कार्तिकमासे कृष्णपक्षे पुण्यायाममावास्यायां तिथौ रविवासरे अमुकगोत्रोत्पन्नः अमुकनामाऽहं श्रुतिस्मृतिपुराणोक्तफलावाप्तिकामनया
ज्ञाताज्ञातकायिकवाचिकमानसिकसकलपापनिवृत्तिपूर्वकं स्थिरलक्ष्मीप्राप्तये श्रीमहालक्ष्मीप्रीत्यर्थं महालक्ष्मीपूजनं कुबेरादीनां च पूजनं करिष्ये। तदङ्गत्वेन गौरीगणपत्यादिपूजनं च करिष्ये।

Meaning: Om, salutations to Vishnu (three times). Today, in this day of Brahma, in the second half of his life, in the Shveta Varaha kalpa, in the 28th age of Vaivasvata Manu, in the first quarter of the Kali Yuga, in the age of the Buddha avatar, on this earth, in Jambudvipa, in Bharat, in the city of ___, in the year named Raudra, in Kartika, the best of months, in the dark fortnight, on the holy Amavasya, on Sunday: I, ___, born in the ___ gotra, seeking the fruit the Shruti, Smriti and Puranas speak of, and first setting down every sin, known and unknown, of body, speech and mind, for Lakshmi who stays, and to please Shri Mahalakshmi, will do the puja of Mahalakshmi and of Kubera and the others. As part of it, I will also do the puja of Gauri, Ganapati and the others.

NKPP pp. 35 and 260. Raudra is this year's samvatsara (Vikram Samvat 2083); रविवासरे = Sunday. Women say गोत्रोत्पन्ना (gotrotpanna).

THE PUJA · STEPS 4 TO 9

Ganeshji first, then Maa Lakshmi's offerings

The one line for every offering in steps 5 to 9. Say **ॐ महालक्ष्म्यै नमः**, then the name of what you offer, then **समर्पयामि** ("I offer").

Bath	**स्नानं समर्पयामि**	Chandan	**गन्धं समर्पयामि**
Akshat	**अक्षतान् समर्पयामि**	Flowers	**पुष्पं समर्पयामि**
Garland	**पुष्पमालां समर्पयामि**	Incense	**धूपं समर्पयामि**
Diya	**दीपं समर्पयामि**	Bhog	**नैवेद्यं समर्पयामि**
Fruit	**ऋतुफलं समर्पयामि**	Paan	**ताम्बूलं समर्पयामि**
Dakshina	**दक्षिणां समर्पयामि**		

For example: *Om mahalakshmyai namah, pushpam samarpayami*, "Om, salutations to Mahalakshmi; I offer this flower."

4 Ganeshji first
गणेश पूजन

Every puja begins with Ganeshji. Offer him tilak, akshat, a flower, durva and a laddoo, saying:

ॐ गं गणपतये नमः ।

Om gam ganapataye namah.

Meaning: Om, salutations to Ganapati.

5 Call Maa Lakshmi

आवाहन · आसन

Hold a flower in folded hands and call her. Then place the flower before her as her seat.

> **ॐ महालक्ष्म्यै नमः । महालक्ष्मीम् आवाहयामि ॥**
>
> *Om mahalakshmyai namah. Mahalakshmim avahayami.*
>
> **Meaning:** Om, salutations to Mahalakshmi. I call you, Mahalakshmi, to be here.

6 Her bath

स्नान

Bathe the coins on the lotus with a little panchamrit, then with clean water. The Gita Press gives the bath to the coins (द्रव्य-लक्ष्मी), so a clay murti is not washed away. With a picture, sprinkle a few drops.

7 Adorn her

श्रृंगार

Chandan with the **ring finger**, then kumkum, akshat coloured with kumkum, red flowers or a lotus, and a garland.

8 Incense, then the diya

धूप · दीप

Show the incense, then the lit ghee diya. Wash your hands.

9 Bhog

नैवेद्य

A sweet with a little water, seasonal fruit, paan with supari and cardamom, and a coin as dakshina.

Steps 4–9: NKPP pp. 261–270. The Gita Press notes that in some regions, by family custom, Maa Lakshmi is offered haldi or dhania in place of akshat, with soaked gud as prasad.

The diyas, the aarti, and forgiveness

10 The diyas
दीपमालिका

Light **11, 21 or more diyas** in a plate and set them near Maa Lakshmi. Offer them chandan and a flower: **ॐ दीपावल्यै नमः**.

> **त्वं ज्योतिस्त्वं रविश्चन्द्रो विद्युदग्निश्च तारकाः ।**
> **सर्वेषां ज्योतिषां ज्योतिर्दीपावल्यै नमो नमः ॥**
>
> *Tvam jyotis tvam ravish chandro vidyud agnish cha tarakah. Sarvesham jyotisham jyotir deepavalyai namo namah.*
>
> **Meaning:** You are light: the sun, the moon, lightning, fire and the stars. Light of all lights, salutations again and again to the row of lamps.

Offer kheel to Ganeshji, Maa Lakshmi and every deity (and sugarcane, oranges or water chestnuts, if your family does). Then **light every diya in the house**.

11 Aarti
आरती

1. Draw a swastika on the thali. Set a ghee wick on a little akshat and flowers, with camphor beside it. Light it and sprinkle the thali with water.
2. The whole family **stands together**, rings the bell and sings **Om Jai Lakshmi Mata** (below).
3. Move the thali **4 times at her feet, 2 at the navel, 1 at the face, then 7 times around her whole form**.
4. Circle a little water around the thali. Offer the aarti to Maa Lakshmi first, then everyone takes it with both palms.

चक्षुर्दं सर्वलोकानां तिमिरस्य निवारणम् ।
आर्तिक्यं कल्पितं भक्त्या गृहाण परमेश्वरि ॥

Chakshurdam sarvalokanam timirasya nivaranam. Artikyam kalpitam bhaktya grihana parameshvari.

Meaning: You who give sight to every world and drive away the dark: accept this aarti, offered with devotion, Supreme Goddess.

NKPP p. ~273 (the nirajan mantra and the family aarti); the 4-2-1-7 count, NKPP p. ~255, "the main rule of aarti".

Om Jai Lakshmi Mata ॐ जय लक्ष्मी माता

The aarti as it is commonly sung; repeat the first line after every verse. Every home sings its own version; keep yours.

ॐ जय लक्ष्मी माता, मैया जय लक्ष्मी माता ।
तुमको निशदिन सेवत, हर विष्णु विधाता ॥
Om jai Lakshmi mata, maiya jai Lakshmi mata. Tumko nishdin sevat, Har Vishnu Vidhata.

उमा रमा ब्रह्माणी, तुम ही जग-माता ।
सूर्य-चन्द्रमा ध्यावत, नारद ऋषि गाता ॥
Uma Rama Brahmani, tum hi jag-mata. Surya-chandrama dhyavat, Narad rishi gata.

दुर्गा रूप निरंजनि, सुख-सम्पत्ति दाता ।
जो कोई तुमको ध्यावत, ऋद्धि-सिद्धि धन पाता ॥
Durga roop niranjani, sukh-sampatti data. Jo koi tumko dhyavat, riddhi-siddhi dhan pata.

तुम पाताल-निवासिनि, तुम ही शुभदाता ।
कर्म-प्रभाव-प्रकाशिनि, भवनिधि की त्राता ॥
Tum patal-nivasini, tum hi shubhdata. Karm-prabhav-prakashini, bhavnidhi ki trata.

जिस घर में तुम रहतीं, सब सद्गुण आता ।
सब सम्भव हो जाता, मन नहिं घबराता ॥
Jis ghar mein tum rahtin, sab sadgun aata. Sab sambhav ho jata, man nahin ghabrata.

तुम बिन यज्ञ न होते, वस्त्र न कोई पाता ।
खान-पान का वैभव, सब तुमसे आता ॥
Tum bin yagya na hote, vastra na koi pata. Khan-paan ka vaibhav, sab tumse aata.

शुभ-गुण-मन्दिर सुन्दर, क्षीरोदधि-जाता ।
रत्न चतुर्दश तुम बिन, कोई नहीं पाता ॥
Shubh-gun-mandir sundar, kshirodadhi-jata. Ratna chaturdash tum bin, koi nahin pata.

महालक्ष्मीजी की आरती, जो कोई नर गाता ।
उर आनन्द समाता, पाप उतर जाता ॥
Mahalakshmiji ki aarti, jo koi nar gata. Ur anand samata, paap utar jata.

12 Flowers, and forgiveness

पुष्पांजलि · क्षमा-प्रार्थना

Flowers in both hands. Offer them, then do a pradakshina and a full pranam.

ॐ महालक्ष्म्यै नमः । मन्त्रपुष्पाञ्जलिं समर्पयामि ॥

Om mahalakshmyai namah. Mantrapushpanjalim samarpayami.

Meaning: Om, salutations to Mahalakshmi. I offer these flowers, with the mantra.

Fold your hands and ask forgiveness:

आवाहनं न जानामि न जानामि विसर्जनम् ।
पूजां चैव न जानामि क्षमस्व परमेश्वरि ॥
मन्त्रहीनं क्रियाहीनं भक्तिहीनं सुरेश्वरि ।
यत्पूजितं मया देवि परिपूर्णं तदस्तु मे ॥

Avahanam na janami na janami visarjanam. Pujam chaiva na janami kshamasva parameshvari. Mantrahinam kriyahinam bhaktihinam sureshvari. Yat pujitam maya devi paripurnam tad astu me.

Meaning: I do not know how to call you, nor how to send you off, nor how to worship you: forgive me, Supreme Goddess. Whatever I offered, short of mantra, of rite, of devotion, O Queen of the gods, let it be made whole.

TO CLOSE

Prasad, and they stay

Pray in the words the Gita Press gives:

त्वमेव माता च पिता त्वमेव ।
त्वमेव बन्धुश्च सखा त्वमेव ।
त्वमेव विद्या द्रविणं त्वमेव ।
त्वमेव सर्वं मम देवदेव ॥

Tvameva mata cha pita tvameva, tvameva bandhush cha sakha tvameva, tvameva vidya dravinam tvameva, tvameva sarvam mama devadeva.

Meaning: You alone are my mother and my father, my kin and my friend, my knowledge and my wealth. You are everything to me, God of gods.

Then let a little water fall, saying:

ॐ अनेन यथाशक्त्यर्चनेन श्रीमहालक्ष्मीः प्रसीदतु ।

Om anena yathashaktyarchanena shri mahalakshmih prasidatu.

Meaning: By this worship, done as well as I could, may Shri Mahalakshmi be pleased.

Bow to the elders. Share charanamrit and prasad.

Maa Lakshmi and Ganeshji are not sent off. They stay. (NKPP: the other invoked deities are given visarjan, but not the new Ganesh and Lakshmi.)

The full vidhi asks far more

Prana-pratishtha, the navagraha, the kalash, the full bath with five substances, the puja of the doorstep, the ledgers, the tijori. This guide is the small part, done right and done with bhaav.

पत्रं पुष्पं फलं तोयं यो मे भक्त्या प्रयच्छति ।
तदहं भक्त्युपहृतमश्नामि प्रयतात्मनः ॥

Patram pushpam phalam toyam yo me bhaktya prayacchati, tad aham bhaktyupahritam ashnami prayatatmanah. (Bhagavad Gita 9.26)

A leaf, a flower, a fruit, a little water: whoever offers it to Me with bhakti, that offering of love I accept.

शुभ दीपावली · Manka · @manka.daily